SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

14 September 2023 · Shift 1

43 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 47 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 1 question

Q.4

Atul sells goods to a customer at a profit of P%. If the cost price of the goods for the customer is ₹1,50,000 and Atul makes a profit of ₹30,000, then what is the value of P?

(A) 22
(B) 25
(C) 20
(D) 28

General Awareness 17 questions

Q.2

'The Palace of Illusions', a rendition of the Hindu epic 'Mahabharata', was written by which of the following novelists?

(A) Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni
(B) Pratibha Ray
(C) Devi Yesodharan
(D) Indu Sundaresan

Q.3

G Krishnakumar was appointed chairman of which of the following in 2023?

(A) Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited
(B) Indian Oil Corporation Limited
(C) Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited
(D) Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited

Q.4

_____ was the first Indian woman to write an autobiography and also the first to do so in Bengali in her book titled 'Aamar Jiban', which was published in 1876.

(A) Rassundari Devi
(B) Manikuntala Sen
(C) Sarala Devi Chaudhurani
(D) Santisudha Ghosh

Q.5

Where is the Vivekanand Rock Memorial situated?

(A) Port Blair
(B) Vishakhapatnam
(C) Kanyakumari
(D) Chennai

Q.6

Under which Act was the rule of British Crown established over India?

(A) Government of India Act 1833
(B) Charter Act of 1813
(C) Regulating Act of 1773
(D) Government of India Act 1858

Q.7

The Kolar region of Karnataka is famous for which mineral from the following?

(A) Coal
(B) Gold
(C) Petroleum
(D) Copper

Q.9

In Fencing, a contest between the two fencers is known as:

(A) bout
(B) remise
(C) parry
(D) riposte

Q.10

In which year has the Government of India instituted Arjuna Award to recognise outstanding achievement in national sports events?

(A) 1961
(B) 1963
(C) 1964
(D) 1962

Q.11

'Atla Taddi', a festival celebrated by married and unmarried women alike to seek the blessings of Devi Gauri for a long and happy married life and a suitable groom, respectively, is celebrated in _____.

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Kerala
(C) Chhattisgarh
(D) Odisha

Q.12

PT Usha was elected as the president of which association in December 2022?

(A) Indian Olympic Association
(B) Haryana Olympic Association
(C) National Rifle Association of India
(D) Badminton Association of India

Q.14

What is the full form of UPSC?

(A) United Public Security Commission
(B) United Power & Security Commission
(C) Union Private Service Committee
(D) Union Public Service Commission

Q.15

To which of the state does Sattriya classical dance belong?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Karnataka
(D) Assam

Q.18

Which of the following is NOT a function of money?

(A) Barter system
(B) Store of value
(C) Unit of account
(D) Medium of exchange

Q.19

According to the Census of India 2011, what was the population density recorded in Bihar?

(A) 1106 persons/km^2
(B) 980 persons/km^2
(C) 1050persons/km^2
(D) 1320 persons/km^2

Q.21

Which Indian musician is associated with the tabla?

(A) Ustad Bismillah Khan
(B) Zakir Hussain
(C) Pandit Ravishankar
(D) Ilaiyaraja

Q.22

On whose advice did Gandhiji spend a year travelling around British India to know the people of India?

(A) Krishnashankar Pandya
(B) Mohammad Ali Jinnah
(C) Shrimad Rajchandra
(D) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Q.24

Which of the following fundamental duties was added to the Indian Constitution by the 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002?

(A) To abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals and institutions, the National Flag and the National Anthem
(B) To protect and to improve the natural environment including forests, lakes, rivers and wildlife, and to have compassion for living creatures
(C) To provide opportunities for education to his/her child or, as the case may be, ward between the age of six and fourteen years
(D) To cherish and follow the noble ideals which inspired our national struggle for freedom

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam was a great man with a high level of _____.

(A) intelligent humour
(B) wise boredom
(C) intellect
(D) clever fatigue

Q.2

The following sentence contains some errors. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. The forses that genarate conditions conduciive to crime and riiots are stronger in urban communities than in rurral areas.

(A) The forsec that genarate conditions conduciive to crime and riots are stronger in urban communities than in rurall areas.
(B) The forces that genereta conditions conducieve to crime and riotts are stronger in urban communities than in rural areas.
(C) The forces that generate conditions conducive to crime and riots are stronger in urban communities than in rural areas.
(D) The forces that genarete conditions conduciive to crime and riots are stronger in urban communities than in ruraal areas.

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. I found my teacher's points "casual and informal" in the group discussion.

(A) flesh and blood
(B) free and easy
(C) foot the bill
(D) fair and square

Q.4

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. One who is all powerful.

(A) Omnipresent
(B) Omnipotent
(C) Optimist
(D) Omniscient

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Ramesh “is owning” a beautiful house in Noida.

(A) did owned
(B) owns
(C) has owning
(D) was owned

Q.6

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. When Nisha will have finished her task?

(A) have
(B) When Nisha will
(C) finished
(D) her task

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. He “push the bushes” aside and went a little farther.

(A) pushed with bush
(B) pushing the bush
(C) pushes in bush
(D) pushed the bushes

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Copying someone else’s work and trying to submit it as your own

(A) Plagiarism
(B) Polygamy
(C) Preamble
(D) Extempore

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Beauty of it

(A) Make things worse
(B) Cause for dispute
(C) Quite ordinary
(D) Good points

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. The girl was “manacled” and locked in the room.

(A) unfastened
(B) liberated
(C) fettered
(D) unbinded

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. Addiction of drugs proved “detrimental” for his health.

(A) Impartial
(B) Potential
(C) Beneficial
(D) Differential

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Plunge

(A) Transgress
(B) Dive
(C) Rush
(D) Fly

Q.13

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Tomatos
(B) Weather
(C) Vehicle
(D) Professor

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option that can rectify the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to rectify it, select 'no rectification needed'. I used a variety of sources to find the "more cheap" flight.

(A) no rectification needed
(B) cheaper
(C) cheapest
(D) cheap

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence. All the members of my family are planning to visit Jammu and Kashmir this Novembur.

(A) Novembur
(B) Planning
(C) Visit
(D) Members

Q.16

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Ravi will go to the England.

(A) the England
(B) will
(C) Ravi
(D) go to

Q.17

Select the most appropriate response in the given situation of the eve of a battle to fill in the blank. The commander: "Honourable Emperor, all the troops have lined up for the battle and are awaiting your orders." Emperor Chandragupta Maurya: "_____."

(A) We will march at dawn.
(B) You should learn how to talk to an emperor.
(C) We will be playing cards.
(D) We are ready for the pilgrimage.

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. We prefer going to movies "once in a blue moon."

(A) Very rarely
(B) Very amazingly
(C) Very diligently
(D) Very often

Q.19

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. My father told me / that in his childhood / he was walking / to school every day.

(A) he was walking
(B) that in his childhood
(C) My father told me
(D) to school every day

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Today's question paper felt "like a cakewalk".

(A) Very sweet
(B) Very tasty
(C) Very easy
(D) Very difficult

Q.21

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Modern football (1)_____in Britain in the 19th century. Since before medieval times, 'folk football' games had been played in towns and villages according to local customs and with a (2)_____of rules. Industrialisation and (3)_____, which reduced the amount of leisure time and space available to the working class, combined with a history of legal prohibitions against particularly (4)_____ and destructive forms of folk football to undermine the game's status from the early 19th century onward. However, football was taken up as a winter game between residence houses at public (independent) schools such as Winchester, Charterhouse and Eton. Each school had its own rules; some allowed limited handling of the ball and others did not. The (5)_____in rules made it difficult for public schoolboys entering university to continue playing except with former schoolmates.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) terminated
(B) culminated
(C) originated
(D) fragmented

Q.22

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Modern football (1)_____in Britain in the 19th century. Since before medieval times, 'folk football' games had been played in towns and villages according to local customs and with a (2)_____of rules. Industrialisation and (3)_____, which reduced the amount of leisure time and space available to the working class, combined with a history of legal prohibitions against particularly (4)_____ and destructive forms of folk football to undermine the game's status from the early 19th century onward. However, football was taken up as a winter game between residence houses at public (independent) schools such as Winchester, Charterhouse and Eton. Each school had its own rules; some allowed limited handling of the ball and others did not. The (5)_____in rules made it difficult for public schoolboys entering university to continue playing except with former schoolmates.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) optimum
(B) variance
(C) minimum
(D) maximum

Q.23

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Modern football (1)_____in Britain in the 19th century. Since before medieval times, 'folk football' games had been played in towns and villages according to local customs and with a (2)_____of rules. Industrialisation and (3)_____, which reduced the amount of leisure time and space available to the working class, combined with a history of legal prohibitions against particularly (4)_____ and destructive forms of folk football to undermine the game's status from the early 19th century onward. However, football was taken up as a winter game between residence houses at public (independent) schools such as Winchester, Charterhouse and Eton. Each school had its own rules; some allowed limited handling of the ball and others did not. The (5)_____in rules made it difficult for public schoolboys entering university to continue playing except with former schoolmates.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) normalisation
(B) urbanisation
(C) standardisation
(D) implementation

Q.24

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Modern football (1)_____in Britain in the 19th century. Since before medieval times, 'folk football' games had been played in towns and villages according to local customs and with a (2)_____of rules. Industrialisation and (3)_____, which reduced the amount of leisure time and space available to the working class, combined with a history of legal prohibitions against particularly (4)_____ and destructive forms of folk football to undermine the game's status from the early 19th century onward. However, football was taken up as a winter game between residence houses at public (independent) schools such as Winchester, Charterhouse and Eton. Each school had its own rules; some allowed limited handling of the ball and others did not. The (5)_____in rules made it difficult for public schoolboys entering university to continue playing except with former schoolmates.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) traces
(B) undercurrents
(C) calm
(D) violent

Q.25

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Modern football (1)_____in Britain in the 19th century. Since before medieval times, 'folk football' games had been played in towns and villages according to local customs and with a (2)_____of rules. Industrialisation and (3)_____, which reduced the amount of leisure time and space available to the working class, combined with a history of legal prohibitions against particularly (4)_____ and destructive forms of folk football to undermine the game's status from the early 19th century onward. However, football was taken up as a winter game between residence houses at public (independent) schools such as Winchester, Charterhouse and Eton. Each school had its own rules; some allowed limited handling of the ball and others did not. The (5)_____in rules made it difficult for public schoolboys entering university to continue playing except with former schoolmates.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) grouse
(B) grunt
(C) variance
(D) control

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.4 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.4 · Answer (B) 25

The customer's cost price is Atul's selling price, ₹1,50,000, so Atul's cost price is 1,50,000 – 30,000 = ₹1,20,000 and P = 30,000/1,20,000 × 100 = 25.

General Awareness

Q.2 · Answer (A) Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni

'The Palace of Illusions' (2008) by Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni retells the Mahabharata from Draupadi's point of view. Pratibha Ray's 'Yajnaseni' also tells Draupadi's story, but in Odia.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited

G. Krishnakumar took charge as Chairman and Managing Director of Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) on 17 March 2023.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Rassundari Devi

Rassundari Devi, a housewife who taught herself to read in secret, wrote 'Amar Jiban' (1876), regarded as the first autobiography in Bengali and the first full-length autobiography by an Indian woman.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Kanyakumari

The Vivekananda Rock Memorial, completed in 1970, stands on a rock in the sea off Kanyakumari, Tamil Nadu, where Swami Vivekananda meditated in December 1892.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Government of India Act 1858

The Government of India Act, 1858, passed after the revolt of 1857, ended the East India Company's rule and transferred the government of India to the British Crown.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Gold

The Kolar Gold Fields in Kolar district, Karnataka, were among the oldest and deepest gold mines in India; they were closed in 2001.

Q.9 · Answer (A) bout

In fencing a 'bout' is the contest between two fencers. A parry blocks the opponent's blade, a riposte is the attack that follows a parry, and a remise renews an attack straight after it has been parried.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 1961

The Arjuna Award, given by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports for outstanding performance in sports, was instituted in 1961.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Andhra Pradesh

Atla Taddi is a festival of Telugu women in Andhra Pradesh (and Telangana), held on the third night after the full moon of Ashvayuja: they fast, offer small dosas (atlu) to Gauri and break the fast after seeing the moon.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Indian Olympic Association

P. T. Usha was elected unopposed as president of the Indian Olympic Association in December 2022, the first woman to head it.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Union Public Service Commission

UPSC is the Union Public Service Commission, the constitutional body (Articles 315-323) that recruits for the all-India and central services.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Assam

Sattriya, created by the Vaishnava saint Srimanta Sankardev and kept alive in Assam's sattras (monasteries), was recognised as a classical dance by the Sangeet Natak Akademi in 2000.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Barter system
Money replaced barter, the direct exchange of goods for goods. Its functions are to serve as a medium of exchange, a unit of account, a store of value and a standard of deferred payment.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 1106 persons/km²
In the 2011 Census Bihar had a population density of 1,106 persons per km², the highest of any state.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Zakir Hussain
Zakir Hussain, son of the tabla player Alla Rakha, was the best-known tabla maestro of his time. Bismillah Khan played the shehnai and Ravi Shankar the sitar, and Ilaiyaraaja is a film composer.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
When Gandhi returned from South Africa in 1915, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, whom he regarded as his political guru, advised him to spend a year travelling around India, observing, before taking any public stand.

Q.24 · Answer (C) To provide opportunities for education to his/her child or, as the case may be, ward between the age of six and fourteen years
The 86th Amendment (2002) added Article 51A(k), the duty of a parent or guardian to provide opportunities for education to a child or ward aged six to fourteen, and inserted Article 21A, the right to education. The other three duties date from 1976.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) intellect
'Intellect', the power of reasoning and understanding, is what 'a high level of' naturally measures in a great mind like Kalam's; 'wise boredom' and 'clever fatigue' make no sense.

Q.2 · Answer (C) The forces that generate conditions conducive to crime and riots are stronger in urban communities than in rural areas.
The correct spellings are 'forces', 'generate', 'conducive', 'riots' and 'rural'; only this option has all of them.

Q.3 · Answer (B) free and easy
'Free and easy' means informal and relaxed. 'Fair and square' is honest, to 'foot the bill' is to pay, and 'flesh and blood' is a human being or one's family.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Omnipotent
'Omnipotent' means all-powerful; 'omnipresent' is present everywhere and 'omniscient' all-knowing.

Q.5 · Answer (B) owns
'Own' is a stative verb and is not used in the continuous: 'Ramesh owns a beautiful house in Noida.'

Q.6 · Answer (B) When Nisha will
A question puts the auxiliary before the subject: 'When will Nisha have finished her task?'

Q.7 · Answer (D) pushed the bushes
The sentence is in the past ('went'), so 'push' must be 'pushed': 'He pushed the bushes aside and went a little farther.'

Q.8 · Answer (A) Plagiarism
'Plagiarism' is passing off someone else's work as one's own. 'Polygamy' is having more than one spouse, a 'preamble' an introduction and 'extempore' speaking without preparation.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Good points
'The beauty of it' is what is especially good or advantageous about something: its good points.

Q.10 · Answer (C) fettered
To be 'manacled' is to have one's hands chained: 'fettered'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Beneficial
'Detrimental' means harmful; its opposite is 'beneficial'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Dive
To 'plunge' is to jump or fall headlong, as into water: 'dive'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Tomatos
The plural of 'tomato' is 'tomatoes'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) cheapest
Picking one flight out of many needs the superlative, and a one-syllable adjective takes '-est': 'the cheapest flight'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Novembur
The correct spelling is 'November'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) the England
The names of most countries take no article: 'Ravi will go to England.'

Q.17 · Answer (A) We will march at dawn.
With the troops lined up and awaiting orders on the eve of battle, the fitting reply is an order: 'We will march at dawn.'

Q.18 · Answer (A) Very rarely
'Once in a blue moon' means very rarely.

Q.19 · Answer (A) he was walking
A habit in the past takes the simple past or 'used to', not the past continuous: 'he walked (or used to walk) to school every day'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Very easy
A 'cakewalk' is something very easy to do.

Q.21 · Answer (C) originated
Modern football 'originated', had its beginnings, in 19th-century Britain; 'culminated' would mean it reached its peak there.

Q.22 · Answer (C) minimum
Folk games were played by local custom 'with a minimum of rules', that is, with very few rules.

Q.23 · Answer (B) urbanisation
'Industrialisation and urbanisation', the growth of factories and towns, together cut the leisure time and space left to the working class.

Q.24 · Answer (D) violent
Laws prohibited 'violent and destructive' forms of folk football; 'violent' pairs with 'destructive', while 'calm' contradicts it.

Q.25 · Answer (C) variance
Each school had its own rules, so the 'variance' (difference) in rules made it hard for schoolboys to play together at university.

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